

due to the payment of insurance premiums and other costs for security. These add on payments would make Bitcoin at par with using credit cards in term so transaction fees and make the whole point of the currency moot.

In the case of the latter four cases Bitcoin users could find their options reducing and since a currency is only as dependent as its acceptance, we would observe a massive crash in the price of the currency. Hundreds, if not thousands, of people would find themselves holding worthless alphanumeric numbers that aren't worth anything in trade. Online merchants would be the first indicator of this shift as they are the most highly dependent on real world currencies. If governments actively oppose virtual currencies instead of remaining neutral or supportive then its even more likely Bitcoin will not even have value on the blackmarket.

A look into the financial crystal ball

The stark reality is this - Bitcoin is a revolutionary innovation that has befuddled regulators and given a new sense of freedom to its users. But all these changes have come at a significant loss of trust by the non-technological community as well as a very anti-regulatory attitude that is built into the currency. These opposing factors ensure that even at the worst of times there will always be Bitcoin users in the world even if they may not be in such large quantities.

Just as even today there are users on the darknet who live completely innocent lives online and do so just to have the freedom of anonymity. The question is of trust and culture. In Eastern nations, there is great mistrust of people who only look out for themselves and don't depend on communities. Just as in Western nations, collective groups are not trusted specially in finance and business, and being mistrustful is considered a virtue since the individual is king. These conflicts of local culture make it unlikely that the features of Bitcoin and similar currencies will make it acceptable to a global user base.

This doesn't mean that Bitcoin is sure to fail - in fact it may discover yet unrealised features such as becoming component of vast business' such as the Steam online infrastructure that already witness'



Many claim to know the future; we discuss the many possible variations.